

Emissions down 44% per person, 80% per unit of GDP?

A statement at COP30, tested against Eurostat data

THE CLAIM

“...reduced its per capita emissions by over 44% compared to 2005 and emissions per unit of GDP by more than 80%.”

Government of Malta, COP30 national statement, November 2025

Delivered on behalf of the Minister for the Environment, Energy and Public Cleanliness.

The statement gives no year and does not say whether GDP is measured in current prices or in volumes.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

Strong decoupling is real; the 80% is a current-price figure.

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

–48%

Per person: the figure is right

Eurostat: –46% to 2023, –48.5% to 2024 (EU –34% and –36%). About half is population growth.

–84%

Per unit of GDP, current prices

Only on this basis is “more than 80%” reached (–82% to 2023). Inflation of the GDP figure adds to the fall.

–72%

Per unit of GDP, volumes

In real terms the fall is –70% (2023) and –72% (2024); no year reaches –80%. EU: –48%.

+161%

Real GDP growth since 2005

Total emissions fell 27% over the same years: real decoupling of growth from emissions.

–27%

Total emissions: less than the EU

EU –33%. Emissions have risen 18% since their 2016 low. The 2030 target is a separate question (CC-003).

FAIR TO SAY

The decoupling the sentence describes is real: output more than doubled while total emissions fell. Malta's intensity fell more than the EU's on either price basis.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The source and method behind “80%”.

☐ Whether GDP is in current prices or volumes.

☐ The year and emissions scope used.

☐ The rest of the statement, to check for context.